

KYLE GAARDER

Community Events Leader | Marketing & Growth | Programming

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SUMMARY

Community event designer and growth operator. Built a portfolio of 48+ events, 4 masterminds, and 6 structured programs from scratch. I design programming that drives member satisfaction and acquisition in shared spaces. My background combines event production with growth marketing - building demand pipelines and converting attendees into long-term members.

For Industrious: I design events that drive member acquisition and retention — 48+ programs from scratch and a 3,140-subscriber growth pipeline.

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
- Designed and produced 48 weekly dinners, 4 mastermind cohorts, and 6 work-trade programs
- Built event-driven growth engine sustaining 94% occupancy retention for 19 consecutive months
- Created member onboarding and engagement loops driving satisfaction and long-term retention
- Executed A/B testing on pricing and event models, generating 48% annual revenue lift
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY across events and facility ops
- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition while maintaining programming continuity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots marketing and outreach
- Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand community preferences and event demand
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led marketing and community growth across strategy, ops, and brand in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



48+ Events from Scratch

Designed and produced 48 dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 programs driving community growth



3,140-Sub Growth Pipeline

Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots marketing and outreach



94% Retention via Events

Event-driven community design sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months



Investor Pilot Secured

Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states



48% Revenue Growth

A/B tested pricing and engagement models driving 48% annual revenue increase

SKILLS

Event Design & Production

Community Marketing

Growth & Demand Generation

Brand Programming Member Acquisition

Retention Stakeholder Management

Vendors Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science, Biology

Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014

📍 Virginia, USA

- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA

3.5 / 4.0